ACTIVITY 038

Diphthong Landing

Diction & Articulation

6 minutes / Word 'day' or another song word.

Coordinate a moving vowel in a sustained English word.

"day"

daa	aa	aa	y
1	2	3	4

Keep the main vowel through beats 1–3. Let the vowel ending arrive near beat 4.

1. Speak 'day' and notice that its vowel changes near the end.
2. Sing the first part of the vowel for three beats, moving gently to its ending on beat four.
3. Apply that timing to the actual phrase, then adjust it to the music's style and duration.

DIRECTOR'S CUE

The vowel change happens together instead of early in some voices.

COMMON TRAP

Moving to the vowel ending too early.

MAKE IT WORK

Use a two-beat word and demonstrate before asking for a response.